Two Winless Seasons, Two Different Failure Profiles

A focused comparison of the 2008 Detroit Lions and 2017 Cleveland Browns

Abstract

Both teams finished 0–16. Detroit had a −249 point differential and allowed 517 points; Cleveland had a −176 differential and allowed 410. Cleveland committed 41 turnovers to Detroit's 29, gained more yards, but scored fewer points.

Scope

Only the 2008 Detroit Lions and 2017 Cleveland Browns are compared.

Results

Detroit scored 268 points and allowed 517 (−249); Cleveland scored 234 and allowed 410 (−176). Detroit allowed 32.31 points per game and 6.4 opponent yards per play; Cleveland allowed 25.63 and 5.1. Cleveland gained 4,942 yards versus Detroit's 4,292 but scored 34 fewer points. Cleveland committed 41 turnovers and 28 interceptions; Detroit had 29 turnovers and 19 interceptions.

Situational performance

Cleveland converted third downs at 33.8% (73/216), compared with Detroit's 28.8% (59/205). Detroit's red-zone touchdown rate was 61.3% (19/31), compared with Cleveland's 48.7% (19/39).

Verdict

Detroit was worse by scoring margin and defensive outcomes. Cleveland was worse in turnovers and drive-scoring efficiency. The overall verdict depends on the metric weights.

Limitations

Raw play-by-play could not be downloaded in this environment, so EPA/play, success rate, explosive-play frequency, full drive-level tables, and play-level special-teams analysis are not computed. Player data are a key-contributor panel rather than a full roster panel.